Sustainability Reporting Requirements

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PREPARED BY Northlake University

Provided by: Northlake University Sustainability Office. Synthetic/illustrative. This describes the sustainability reporting we need the system to support: ENERGY STAR benchmarking, greenhouse-gas (GHG) emissions, and our targets.

ENERGY STAR Portfolio Manager

We benchmark our properties in ENERGY STAR Portfolio Manager and want the system to support property setup, rating requests, and score history.

Property	Primary function	Score expectation
Northlake Main Campus (parent)	College/University	metrics only (no 1–100 score)
Admin Hall	Office, with a classroom wing	metrics only (the classroom wing is more than a quarter of the building, so no 1–100 score)
Science Center	Laboratory	metrics only (no 1–100 score)
Library	Library	metrics only (no 1–100 score)
Student Center	Food Service	metrics only (no 1–100 score)
Lakeview Residence Hall	Residence Hall/Dormitory	1–100 score
Recreation and Aquatics Center	Fitness Center/Health Club/Gym, with an indoor pool	metrics only (no 1–100 score)
Parking Structure	Parking, benchmarked on its own and excluded from the campus floor area	metrics only (no 1–100 score)
Cedar Row Apartments	Multifamily Housing (dedicated student housing)	1–100 score
Central Plant	Other - Utility, outside the campus boundary	metrics only (no 1–100 score)

The campus buildings roll up to the campus parent. Cedar Row A, Cedar Row B and the Common House are the buildings within the Cedar Row property. The Ridgeline Wind Site is a generating site, not a building, and is not benchmarked.

We understand **scores come from Portfolio Manager** (not entered by hand) and that Portfolio Manager scores only some property types. Please plan to connect our Portfolio Manager account (a test/sandbox account is fine for setup) and synchronize scores; we want **quarterly** score history for 2024–2025 for the scored properties, showing a modest improvement trend, and metrics for the rest.

Greenhouse-gas emissions

We report emissions by scope and want them computed from our usage:

Scope	Sources	Factor basis
Scope 1 (direct)	Natural gas; thermal plant combustion	EPA stationary combustion
Scope 2 (purchased)	Purchased electricity	eGRID (Sacramento/CAMX region)
Scope 3 (indirect)	Water/sewer embedded energy	conveyance + treatment factor

- We want emission factors maintained with **effective dates** (a factor can change between 2024 and 2025).
- Onsite **solar** should show as a **market-based Scope 2 reduction**; we **retain the RECs** (per the Helios PPA), so please reflect that in market-based accounting and avoided-emissions reporting.
- Off-site **wind** from Ridgeline gets the same treatment: we retain those RECs, and its generation should be reported as **avoided emissions** at the grid factor. Ridgeline's station service is ordinary Scope 2 electricity. Count the turbine meters' generation, not the Valley Electric bill credit, which is money.
- By the grid factor we mean the same dated eGRID factor as Scope 2. Helios's statements print an avoided-CO2e figure of their own; keep it as Helios's disclosure, but report ours at the grid factor.

Targets & cadence

- Track building **energy use intensity (EUI)** and **cost intensity**, ranked across our buildings.
- Annual emissions report by scope and property; quarterly ENERGY STAR scores.
- We have energy projects (LED retrofit, central plant chiller upgrade, solar expansion, recommissioning, the WTG-07 gearbox replacement) and want **measurement & verification** against a baseline.
- For the wind farm, the target is **performance against what the wind made possible**: generated energy over the turbines' own possible power, per turbine and for the farm, over any period we choose.

Open items

- Confirm Portfolio Manager account/credentials for the sync.
- Confirm the eGRID subregion and gas combustion factors to use.
- Confirm baseline year for EUI/emissions targets.